

Species: PURPLE FINCH

Carpodacus purpureus

(Vernacular Name)

(Scientific Name-use binomial) *right*

Date(s): Jan 1 - Feb 5, 1975

Time Bird Seen: seen at least 15 times mostly A.M.

Locality: 247 Melrose

Nearest Town: Pueblo Colo

County: Pueblo

Other observers who independently identified this bird:

NAME	ADDRESS	TELEPHONE
<u>Dave C. Griffiths</u>	<u>Pueblo</u>	
<u>Carolyn C. Griffiths</u>	<u>27 Amherst apt 8</u>	<u>561-2358</u>
<u>Steve & Ronald Simpson</u>	<u>247 Melrose Pueblo Colo 81005</u>	<u>543-4669</u>

Optical Equipment: 7x35 binoculars, naked eye

If photographed, type of equipment used:

Light Conditions: from poor to excellent

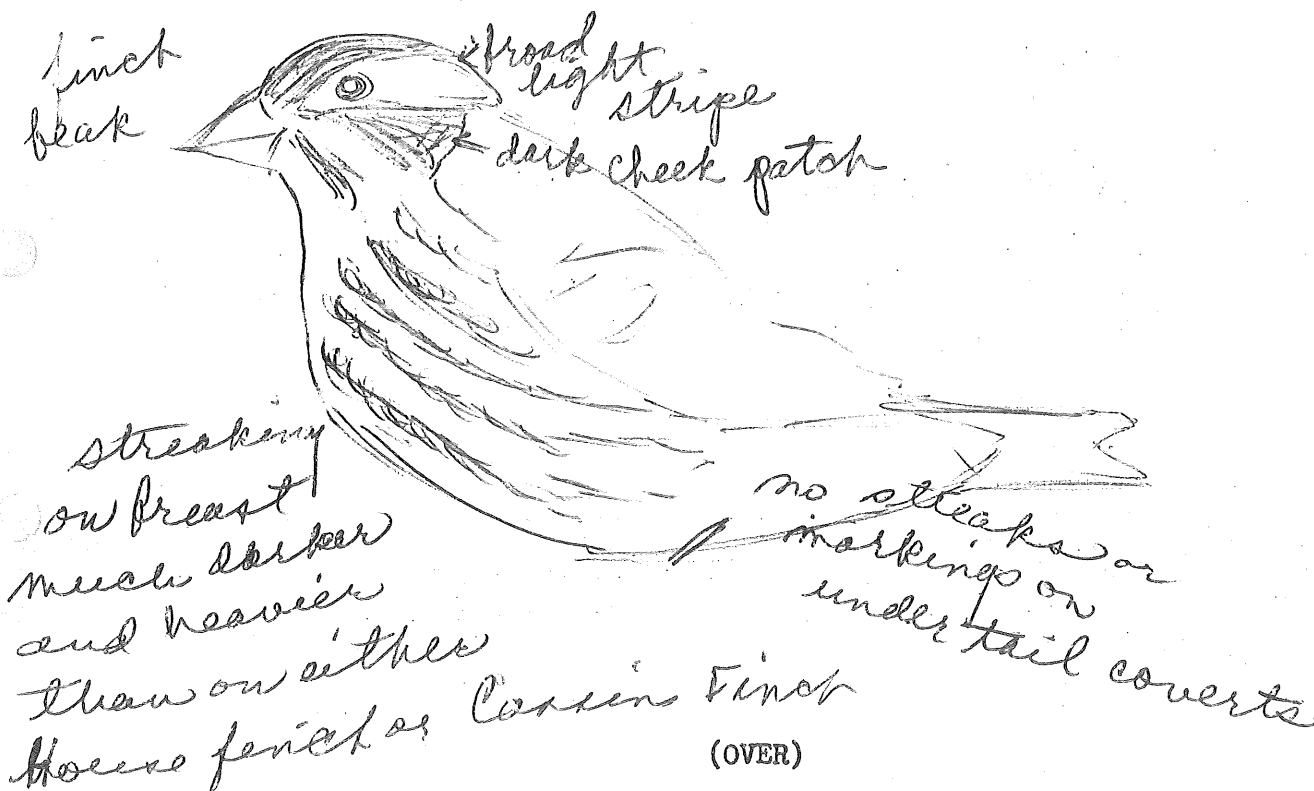
Distance from bird (how measured): as close as 2 feet - known distance from feeder

Number of Birds Seen: 1 Sex: ♀? Plumage: female or immature male

Describe the bird's overall behavior and demeanor:

a finch distinct from House finches that it came in to feed with - seemed more wary at first. had more definite feeding pattern - never seen in afternoon after 12:30 p.m.

Describe in great detail the bird's size, overall shape, plumage and color-pattern. Include details on shape of bill, wings and tail. Give particular emphasis to the marks you used to identify the bird. Reference to its resemblance in field guide descriptions is not enough. Describe what you actually saw in the field:



(OVER)

Describe the bird's song or call, if heard, including method of delivery, i.e., from perch, in flight, etc:

was not able to pick out a distinct or separate call because we watched it from inside of house

Describe the habitat in which you observed this bird:

would come in and land in small pear tree or on power line and then drop to long feeder to eat mostly sun flower seeds

How were similarly appearing species eliminated?

female Cassin's finch does not have as distinct a face pattern. breast streaking isn't as bold and heavy. female House finch has least bold pattern of the 3 finches mentioned

"page 224 Pough Eastern Land Birds - Purple Finch Identification. "Young males breed and sing in plumage like the female's but they may be more yellowish or olive-yellow, especially on the rump." Carolyn and I wondered if this bird may have been a young male because we noted yellowish color in light above the rump."

Prior experience with this and similarly appearing species:

I have seen hundreds if not thousands of House Finches. Probably more than a hundred Cassin's Finch. I have examined a Purple Finch the band a year or so before in Pueblo which was photographed. I saw a small group of Purple finches both adult male & female in Calif. Mar 1974

Books, illustrations and advice consulted and how did these influence this documentation?

Birds of North America Golden Press
Audubon Guides - All the Birds of Eastern and Central North America Richard H Pough see page 224

This report was written from notes made during ___ after X observation; from memory X

PRINT NAME: DAVE A. GRIFFITHS SIGNATURE: Dave Griffiths DATE: June 27 75
Street Address: 27 Amherst Apt 8 Town and State: Pueblo Colo ZIP: 81005

Return to: JACK REDDALL - 4450 South Alton Street, Englewood, Colorado 80110